Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

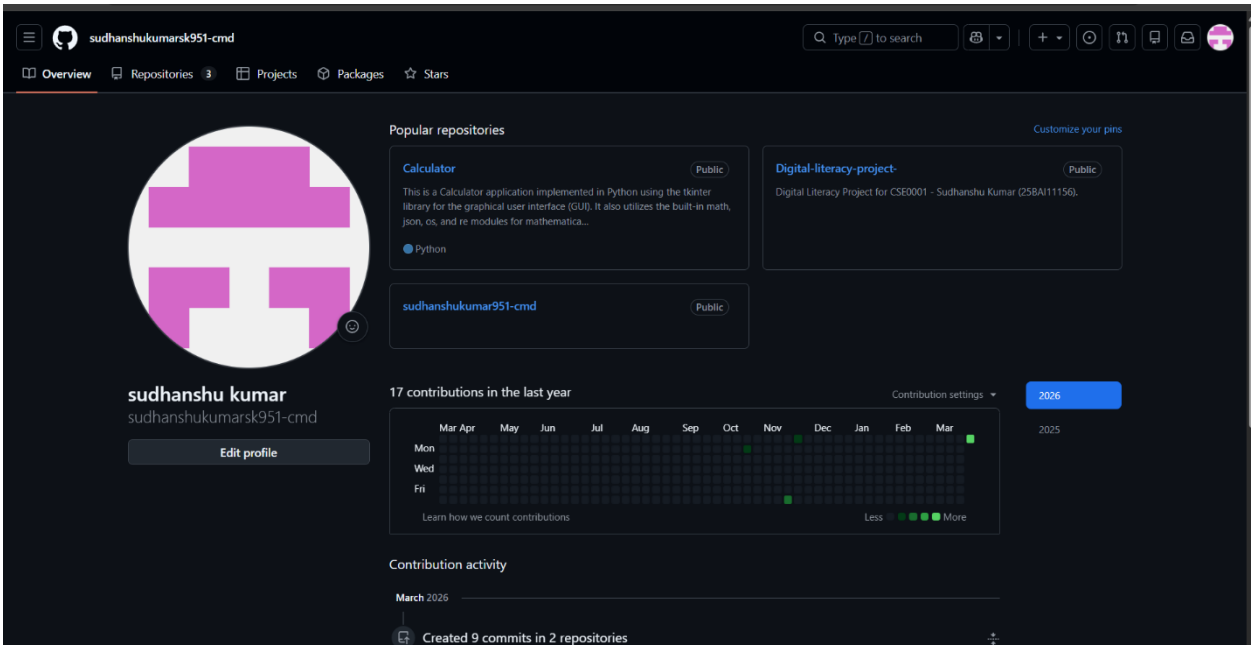
As a Student Digital Ambassador, this project focuses on building essential digital literacy skills required in today's academic and professional environment. It involves understanding safe internet practices, creating a professional digital presence, using collaboration tools, and being aware of cyber threats. Through this project, I explored platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank, and learned professional communication through email writing. I also gained awareness about cybercrime and prevention methods. Overall, this project helped me become more responsible, confident, and aware while using digital technologies.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Infographic

I created my infographic using an online design tool called Canva, which provides easy templates, icons, and color combinations for beginners. My design is titled "Digital Skills for Students" and it covers key topics such as digital literacy, useful digital tools, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. Each section includes a short explanation of two to three lines along with simple visuals to make the information easy to understand. The layout is divided into clear sections with different colors, helping viewers quickly identify each topic. While creating the infographic, I found it interesting to choose icons and visuals that match each concept, like a shield for internet safety and a laptop for digital tools. However, one difficulty I faced was keeping the text short while still explaining each point clearly. It required careful editing to make sure the content was informative but not overcrowded. Overall, this project helped me improve both my design and summarizing skills.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio

For my professional digital portfolio, I have established and updated profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms were selected because they represent the essential pillars of a modern engineering identity: technical version control, professional networking, and data science proficiency. GitHub serves as my primary repository for code and collaborative projects, allowing me to showcase my technical growth. LinkedIn acts as my professional storefront, connecting me with the global academic and industrial community at VIT Bhopal. Kaggle is specifically aligned with my specialization in AI/ML, providing a platform to engage with real-world datasets and competitive machine learning. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms strategically. I will use GitHub to document every major academic project, ensuring a transparent history of my coding journey. On LinkedIn, I intend to build a network of mentors and industry professionals to stay updated on internship opportunities. Finally, I will use Kaggle to transition from a learner to a contributor by participating in data challenges. Together, these profiles will form a comprehensive digital footprint that demonstrates my readiness for the professional world upon graduation in 2029.


sudhanshukumarsk951-cmd
Type / to search
Overview
Repositories 3
Projects
Packages
Stars
Popular repositories
Customize your pins
Calculator
Public
This is a Calculator application implemented in Python using the tkinter library for the graphical user interface (GUI). It also utilizes the built-in math, json, os, and re modules for mathematica...
Python
Digital-literacy-project-
Public
Digital Literacy Project for CSE0001 - Sudhanshu Kumar (25BAI11156).
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Public
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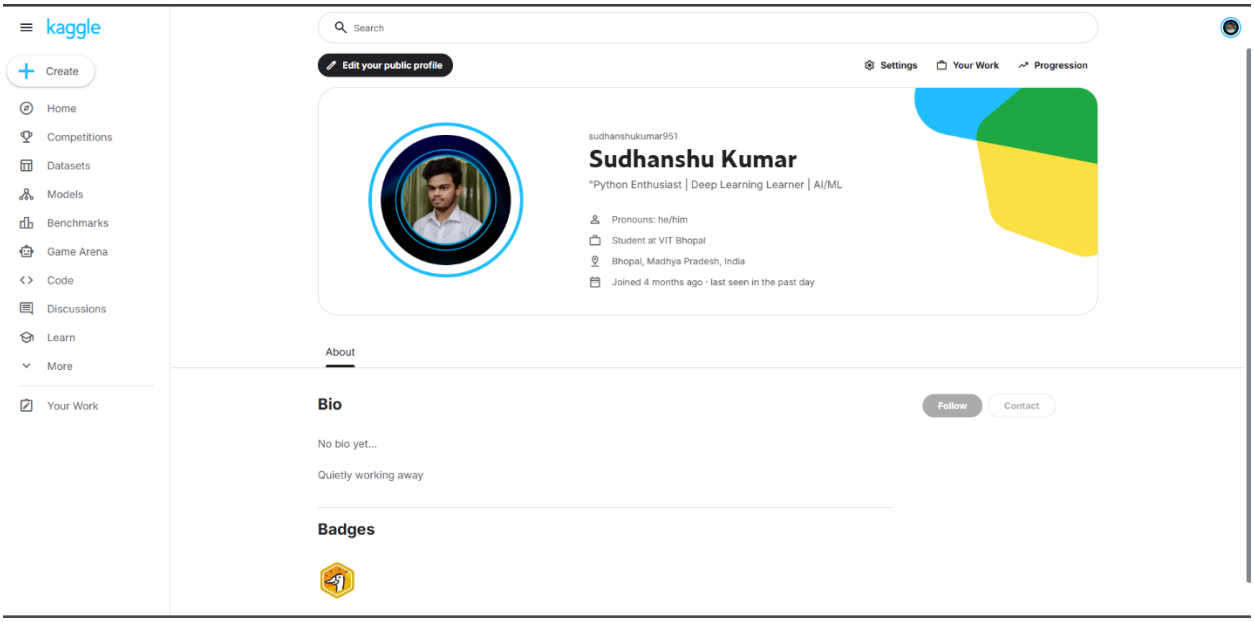
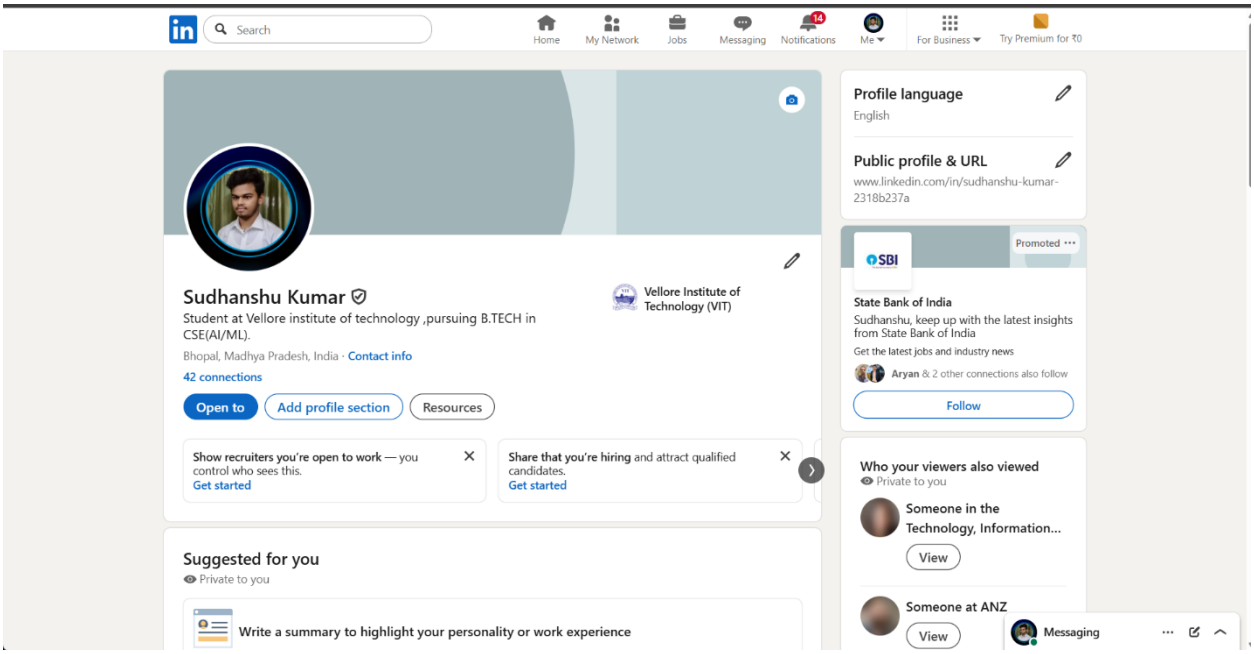
Edit profile
17 contributions in the last year
Contribution settings
2026
2025
Mar Apr May Jun Jul Aug Sep Oct Nov Dec Jan Feb Mar
Mon
Wed
Fri
Learn how we count contributions
Less More
Contribution activity
March 2026
Created 9 commits in 2 repositories


kaggle
Search
Create
Home
Competitions
Datasets
Models
Benchmarks
Game Arena
Code
Discussions
Learn
More
Your Work
Edit your public profile
Settings
Your Work
Progression
sudhanshukumar951
Sudhanshu Kumar
"Python Enthusiast | Deep Learning Learner | AI/ML
Pronouns: he/him
Student at VIT Bhopal
Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, India
Joined 4 months ago · last seen in the past day
About
Bio
Follow
Contact
No bio yet...
Quietly working away
Badges



Task 3: Platforms

For the coding practice portion of this task (Part A), I utilized **HackerRank** to complete a beginner-level technical challenge. To address the cloud collaboration requirement (Part B), I used **Google Forms** and **Google Sheets** to develop and manage a digital literacy assessment tool.

Work Completed and Practice

- **Coding Practice**: I successfully completed the **'Solve Me First'** challenge on HackerRank. This involved writing a basic script to sum two integers, allowing me to practice the standard input/output workflow used in competitive programming.
- **Cloud Collaboration**: I designed a **'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz'** using Google Forms. The form consists of exactly five questions, including both multiple-choice and short-answer formats to test peer knowledge on digital safety and tools. I also initialized the linked Google Sheet to track and organize potential responses.

Academic and Professional Utility

These tools are highly beneficial for my academic journey at VIT Bhopal. Platforms like HackerRank provide a structured environment to improve my problem-solving skills and prepare for technical interviews. Meanwhile, mastering Google Workspace tools like Forms and Sheets is essential for collaborative research, data collection, and organizing project information effectively with my peers.

Untitled form

All changes saved in Drive

Published

Questions Responses Settings

Digital Literacy Quiz

Form description

1. True or False: Anything you post online—even if deleted later—can contribute to your "Digital Footprint" and may be seen by future recruiters. *

- True
- False

2. You receive an "urgent" email from an unknown address claiming your university account will be deleted unless you click a link to verify your identity. What is this an example of? *

- Categorization
- Phishing
- Digital Archiving
- Spam Filtering

3. When using a Creative Commons licensed image for a presentation, what is the most important step to take? *

- Edit the image to make it look original.
- Provide proper attribution to the original creator.

HackerRank | Prepare > Python > Introduction > Python If-Else

Exit Full Screen View

Problem

Submissions

Leaderboard

Discussions

- If n is odd, print `Weird`
- If n is even and in the inclusive range of 2 to 5, print `Not Weird`
- If n is even and in the inclusive range of 6 to 20, print `Weird`
- If n is even and greater than 20, print `Not Weird`

Input Format

A single line containing a positive integer, n.

Constraints

- $1 \leq n \leq 100$

Output Format

Print `Weird` if the number is weird. Otherwise, print `Not Weird`.

Sample Input 0

```
3
```

Sample Output 0

```
Weird
```

Explanation 0

$n = 3$

You have earned 10.00 points!

You are now 26 points away from the 1st star for your python badge.

29% 10/35

Congratulations

You solved this challenge. Would you like to challenge your friends?

Next Challenge

- Test case 0
- Test case 1
- Test case 2
- Test case 3
- Test case 4
- Test case 5
- Test case 6

Compiler Message

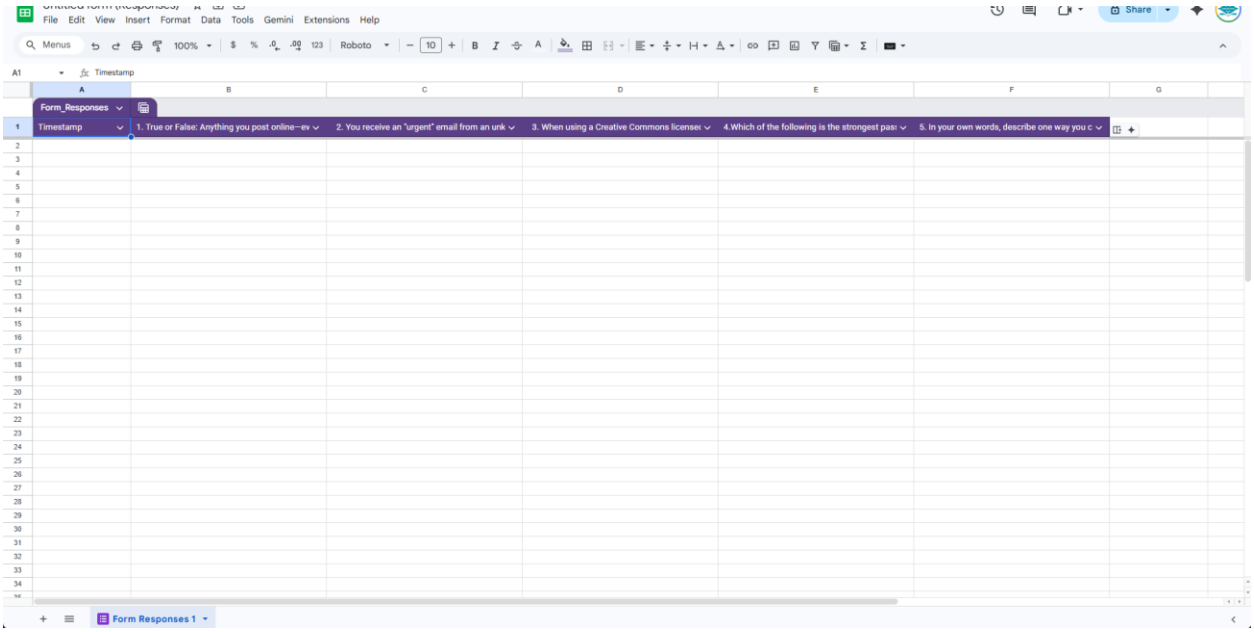
```
Success
```

Input (stdin) Download

```
3
```

Expected Output Download

```
Weird
```



Task 4: Email Etiquette

Communication Scenario and Reflection

Professional digital communication is a critical skill for a Student Digital Ambassador, as it ensures clarity and maintains formal boundaries in an academic and corporate environment. For this task, I drafted two distinct professional emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor and another expressing interest in a summer internship to a coordinator. I focused on ensuring each had a clear subject line, a formal greeting, and a concise body to respect the recipient's time.

One situation where poor digital communication can cause significant problems is the use of an unclear or "urgent" subject line for a non-urgent matter, which can lead to a professor overlooking a genuine request or feeling overwhelmed by perceived demands. By applying a structured approach—stating the purpose early and using a professional sign-off—I learned that tone is just as important as the information being conveyed.

Part A – Write two professional emails:

Email 1 — Write an email from a student to their professor requesting an extension on an assignment submission deadline. The email must follow all professional email rules.

Subject: Extension Request

Dear Professor

I hope this email finds you well.

I am writing to respectfully request an extension for the Assignment due on 25-03=26. Due to a heavy mid-term exam schedule, I am finding it difficult to complete the assignment to the standard I aim for by the current deadline.

Would it be possible to submit my work by 30=03-26 instead? I am committed to ensuring the quality of the submission and would greatly appreciate your consideration of this request.

Thank you for your time and for all the guidance you provide in [Course Name].

Best regards,

Sudhanshu Kumar

B.Tech CSE (AI & ML)

Email 2 — Write an email from a student to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity.

Subject: Inquiry: Summer Internship Opportunities

Dear co-ordinator

My name is Sudhanshu Kumar, and I am currently pursuing a B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering with a specialization in AI and Machine Learning at VIT Bhopal University. I am writing to express my strong interest in a summer internship opportunity with Microsoft.

I have been following Microsoft's work in software development, and I am impressed by your recent projects. With a solid foundation in Python, data visualization, and linear algebra, I am eager to apply my technical skills in a professional environment and contribute to your team's goals.

Attached is my resume for your review. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background in AI/ML and programming could benefit Microsoft this summer.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Sudhanshu Kumar

```
# Responsible Social Media Use: Checklist for College Students

### The Do's
1. **Do Audit Your Privacy Settings:** Regularly check who can see your posts on platforms like Instagram and Facebook.
2. **Do Think Before You Post:** Ask yourself if you would be comfortable with a professor or future recruiter seeing the content.
3. **Do Fact-Check Before Sharing:** Verify news or academic information from multiple reliable sources before hitting 'Share'.
4. **Do Use Professional Language:** Maintain a level of decorum when engaging in public forums or university-related groups.
5. **Do Give Credit:** Always tag or mention original creators when sharing their work, photos, or research.

### The Don'ts
1. **Don't Share Sensitive Info:** Never post your VIT registration number, home address, or phone number publicly.
2. **Don't Engage with Trolls:** Avoid heated, disrespectful arguments that could negatively impact your digital reputation.
3. **Don't Post During Lectures:** Focus on academic integrity and stay present during university sessions.
4. **Don't Cyberbully:** Avoid participating in "roasting" or spreading rumors about batchmates or faculty.
5. **Don't Click Suspicious Links:** Avoid "too good to be true" offers or unknown tags that could lead to account phishing.
```

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness

Research Reflections

While researching the mechanics of digital fraud for this task, I was most surprised by the psychological tactics used in **UPI-based scams**, where attackers exploit a sense of urgency or fear to bypass a user's logical thinking. Learning how easily a professional-looking link or a "request money" button on a UPI app can be misinterpreted by an unsuspecting user was eye-opening.

Personal Impact and Habit Change

As a result of this research and my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, I have decided to implement a **"Think Before You Click"** rule for every unsolicited communication I receive. Specifically, I will now verify the identity of any sender requesting financial action through a secondary, trusted channel before interacting with any links or QR codes. This proactive habit is essential for maintaining financial safety in an increasingly digital academic environment.

Case Study: The "Digital Lutera" UPI Bypass

SOURCE LINK :-https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/india/cyber-fraudsters-using-new-tech-to-bypass-upi-security-for-financial-transactions-report/articleshow/129446735.cms?from=mdr

The Crime: Device-Trust Manipulation
The crime is a sophisticated form of Account Takeover (ATO) fraud that utilizes a specialized malware toolkit known as "Digital Lutera." Unlike standard phishing, which relies on social engineering to steal a PIN, this "structural attack" bypasses the core security pillar of UPI: SIM-binding. By compromising the smartphone's operating system, fraudsters can register and control a victim's UPI account on a completely different device without ever possessing the physical SIM card.

How It Typically Happens (Step-by-Step):

Infection: The victim is lured into installing a malicious APK file, often disguised as a routine document like a wedding invitation, a government traffic fine notice, or a courier tracking app.

Permission Granting: Once installed, the app requests "SMS Permissions." Users often grant this unknowingly, thinking it is required for the app's fake function.

System Manipulation: The "Digital Lutera" framework intercepts registration messages sent between the bank and the device. It uses a specialized framework to trick the UPI app into believing the verification SMS originated from the victim's trusted device.

Remote Control: OTPs and verification codes are silently forwarded to the attacker via private Telegram channels. The attacker then registers the victim's UPI profile on their own hardware.

Evidence Scrubbing: To prevent suspicion, the malware inserts fake "sent" entries into the victim's SMS logs, making the automated verification process look legitimate.

Target Audience:
The primary targets are everyday smartphone users in India, particularly those who frequently use digital payments and may be susceptible to clicking links in unsolicited messages (Smishing).

Consequences:
The consequences are rapid and severe. Reports indicate that small groups of fraudsters can process ₹25–30 lakh in stolen funds in as little as two days. Because the attack happens at the system level, traditional safeguards like app signature checks fail, leading to total account drainage before the victim realizes their "trusted" device has been compromised.

'Stay Safe Online' Checklist: College Student Edition
For college students in India, digital life is integrated into everything from UPI payments at the canteen to submitting assignments on LMS portals. Stay ahead of scammers with these 8 actionable tips:

1.Verify Before You 'Accept' (UPI Safety): Never enter your UPI PIN to receive money. If a stranger or a "buyer" on an unverified marketplace sends you a "Collect Request" or a QR code claiming it's for a refund or payment to you, decline it immediately.

2.Avoid 'Screen Share' for Support (Financial Safety): Technical support for banks or payment apps (GPay, PhonePe, Paytm) will never ask you to download apps like AnyDesk, TeamViewer, or RustDesk. These allow fraudsters to see your OTPs and PINs in real-time as you type them.

3.Audit Your App Permissions: Go to your phone settings and check which apps have "SMS" and "Microphone" access. Malicious APKs (like fake "Exam Result" or "Scholarship" trackers) use SMS permissions to silently forward your bank OTPs to hackers.

4.Secure Your 'Edu' Identity: Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on your university email and personal Gmail accounts. This ensures that even if someone phishes your password, they cannot access your academic records or personal data without the second code on your phone.

5.Beware of 'Job' & 'Internship' Scams: Be skeptical of unsolicited WhatsApp or Telegram messages offering "Part-time work-from-home" or "YouTube Like" jobs. If they ask for a "security deposit" or "registration fee" to start working, it is a scam.

6.Use 'Incognito' on Lab Computers: When using library or computer lab systems, never click "Remember Me" or "Save Password." Always log out manually and clear the browser cache before leaving the station to prevent session hijacking.

7.Identify 'Smishing' Links: Do not click on links in SMS messages claiming your "Electricity will be disconnected," "Bank KYC is expired," or "Free 5G Data offer." Always use official apps or websites to check your status.

8.Vigilance on Public Wi-Fi: Avoid conducting banking transactions or entering passwords while connected to free railway or cafe Wi-Fi. If you must use it, use a trusted VPN to encrypt your data traffic.

How to Report Cybercrime
If you or someone you know has been cheated or harassed online:

Call Immediately: Dial 1930 (National Cyber Crime Helpline). Acting within the "Golden Hour" (first 2 hours) increases the chances of freezing stolen funds.

Report Online: File a formal complaint at the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: www.cybercrime.gov.in.

Conclusion

The Digital Literacy project has been a transformative experience, bridging the gap between basic internet usage and professional digital citizenship. By completing these five tasks, I have not only secured a foundational digital presence on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn but also developed a critical eye for online safety and professional communication standards. This project has reinforced that being digitally literate is not just about technical skills, but about navigating the digital world with responsibility, security, and a professional mindset. These tools and habits will serve as a permanent asset throughout my academic career at VIT Bhopal and beyond.

References

- Canva – https://www.canva.com
- GitHub – https://github.com
- LinkedIn – https://linkedin.com
- Kaggle – https://kaggle.com
- HackerRank – https://hackerrank.com
- Google Forms –https://forms.gle/p6b5yJnCLHgMT7uM9
- Cyber Crime Portal – https://www.cybercrime.gov.in
- README link -https://github.com/sudhanshukumarsk951-cmd/Digital-literacy-project-/blob/main/README.md

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